'Really? I had no news of that. But …'

Sasanka uncle looked at the fifteen ten-rupee notes in his hand and then looked at Aditya. There was a completely new expression on his face. He said, 'Aditya, this smacks too much of charity. Doesn't it?'

We remained silent. Peering intently at Aditya, Sasanka Sanyal smiled and said, 'I had recognised you at Nagen *uncle*'s tea shop by that mole on your right cheek. I could see you had not recognised me. So I recited the same poem that I had recited on the prize-giving day, on purpose, so that you may remember. Then, when you came to visit me, I couldn't help venting my anger on you.'

'You have done the right thing. Your grievances are absolutely justified. But I will be happy if you accept the money,' said Aditya.

Sasanka Sanyal shook his head and said, 'No. Money will soon be spent. I would have preferred to have the medal if it were possible. I would have forgotten that unpleasant incident of my childhood if I could get the medal back.'

So, the medal that had been hidden in the attic for twenty-nine long years was eventually restored to its owner.

'Sriman Sasanka Sanyal – Special Prize for Recitation - 1948' was still clearly engraved on it **(Translated from the Bengali story Chilekotha)**

p. Why did Sanyal recite the poem in the tea shop earlier?

q. What was engraved on the medal?

About the Author:



Satyajit Ray (1921 - 1992) was an Indian film maker, screen writer, graphic artist, music composer and author. He was born in Kolkatta. He authored several short stories and novels meant primarily for young children and teenagers. He revived the children's magazine 'Sandesh' (which his grandfather had started in 1913) and edited it until his death in 1992. Ray was more interested in writing, rather than film making. His stories have been translated in Europe, the United States and many other countries. Ray received many awards including 32 national film awards by the Government of India, notably the Padma Bhushan in 1965 and the highest civilian honour 'Bharat Ratna' shortly before his death.

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